BABYSTEPS · PROJECT DOCUMENT

User research plan and template

A ready-to-run plan for talking to first-time parents. Findings stay empty until the sessions happen.

PROJECT
BabySteps

PREPARED BY
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VERSION
1.0, draft for review

DATE
October 15, 2026

CONFIRMED from the built app or from you ESTIMATE my working figure
PROPOSED a plan or target to test SOURCED from a cited public page TO CONFIRM needs your input

> Findings are not included. No interviews have been run for this document, and no result is invented here. Fill in the findings log after the sessions. TO CONFIRM

Goals

- Learn how first-time parents track feeds, sleep, diapers, growth and vaccines today.
- Test whether country-specific guidance (units, vaccine schedule, finance topics) matters to them.
- Find out how they keep memories and who they would share a time capsule with.
- Decide whether the chatbot and the shared time capsule deserve to be built next.

Research questions

#	QUESTION	DECISION IT INFORMS
RQ1	What do parents use today to track their baby, and what makes them stop?	Whether the daily log needs to be simpler
RQ2	Where do parents look for health, food and money guidance, and do they trust it?	How guidance is sourced and labeled
RQ3	Does living in a different country from family or advice sources change what they need?	Whether country-awareness is the lead message
RQ4	How do they handle vaccines and appointments?	Whether to add reminders
RQ5	Which questions would they ask a chatbot, and what would make them distrust it?	Chatbot scope and guardrails
RQ6	Who would they invite to a shared time capsule, and what would they write or add?	Shared capsule design

Method

METHOD	SAMPLE	LENGTH	PURPOSE
Semi-structured interview	8 to 10 parents	30 to 40 minutes	Depth on habits and needs (RQ1 to RQ6)
Concept and usability test	Same participants, last 10 minutes	10 minutes	Five tasks on the working app
Short survey	30 or more responses	4 minutes	Check how common the interview themes are

> Sample sizes are my proposal. Eight to ten interviews is usually enough to see repeated themes. A survey of 30 gives direction, not statistics. PROPOSED

Who to recruit

GROUP	COUNT	WHY
Parent of a baby aged 0 to 12 months, living in the US	3 to 4	Core user for the US schedule
Parent of a baby aged 0 to 12 months, living in India	3 to 4	Core user for the IAP schedule and metric units
Parent living away from their home country	2	Tests the country-awareness idea directly
Grandparent or partner who would contribute to a time capsule	1 to 2	Tests the shared capsule

Screener questions

1. Do you have a child under 18 months, or are you expecting your first? (Continue if yes.)
2. Is this your first child? (Prefer yes; include at most 2 second-time parents.)
3. Which country do you live in now? Which country did you grow up in?
4. Which apps, notes or paper do you use to track your baby today?
5. Are you comfortable being recorded for note-taking? You can stop at any time. (Required)

Recruitment

- Message friends of friends, student groups and community groups with a short note and the screener link. PROPOSED
- Offer a small thank-you, such as a gift card. Amount to be set by the budget. PROPOSED
- Do not recruit through the app's own users until the beta. PROPOSED

Consent and care

- Explain the purpose, the recording and how notes are stored before starting.
- Do not ask for the baby's medical records, photos or any identifying health detail.
- Store notes under a participant code, not a name. Delete recordings after synthesis.
- Offer to stop at any point. Treat parenting stress as sensitive and keep the tone warm.

Interview guide (35 minutes)

TIME	SECTION	PROMPTS
0:00	Opening (3 min)	Thank them, explain the goal, ask permission to record. "Tell me about your baby and how the last month has been."
0:03	Current habits (8 min)	"Walk me through yesterday." "What do you write down, and where?" "What did you stop tracking and why?"
0:11	Guidance and trust (8 min)	"When you had a question about feeding, sleep or vaccines, where did you look?" "Was anything wrong for where you live?" "Have you thought about saving or planning money for your baby? Where did you find advice?"
0:19	Memories (4 min)	"How do you keep photos and moments?" "Who sees them?" "Would you write something to read in the future? To whom?"
0:23	Concept test (8 min)	Show BabySteps. Five tasks below. Ask them to think aloud.
0:31	Wrap-up (4 min)	"What would make you use this weekly?" "What would make you delete it?" "Anything I should have asked?"

Usability tasks

TASK	SUCCESS MEASURE
Create a baby profile and choose your country	Done without help in under 2 minutes
Log a diaper change and a feed	Done in under 1 minute
Find the vaccine schedule for your country	Found without prompting
Find a finance or savings guide	Found without prompting
Add a photo and write a locked letter	Done without help

Survey (12 questions)

1. Your country of residence (list).
2. Baby's age band.
3. First child? (yes/no)
4. How do you track your baby today? (multi-select)
5. How often do you track? (daily, a few times a week, rarely)
6. Which topics did you search for guidance on? (feeding, sleep, vaccines, growth, money, other)
7. How much do you trust online baby advice? (1 to 5)
8. Has advice ever not applied where you live? (yes/no/unsure; if yes, describe)
9. How important is a vaccine schedule for your country? (1 to 5)
0. Would you use a chatbot for baby questions? (yes/maybe/no; why)
1. Would you share a time capsule with family? (yes/maybe/no; with whom)
2. Any other comment (optional).

Note-taking template

PARTICIPANT	DATE	COUNTRY	BABY AGE	QUOTE	OBSERVATION	THEME TAG	NEED OR PAIN
P01							
P02							
P03							

Synthesis method

1. Write each quote or observation on its own note, with the participant code.
2. Group notes into themes on an affinity map. Name each theme as a sentence.
3. Count how many participants raised each theme. A theme needs at least 3 participants to count as a pattern.
4. Turn each pattern into an insight, then into a "How might we" question.
5. Compare insights with the scope document and propose changes through change control.

Findings log (complete after the sessions)

THEME	PARTICIPANTS RAISING IT	EVIDENCE (SHORT QUOTE)	INSIGHT	CHANGE TO SCOPE

Schedule

WEEK	ACTIVITY
1	Finalize screener and guide, run 2 pilot sessions, recruit
2	Run 8 interviews, open the survey
3	Close the survey, synthesize, write the findings report, review at gate G3

How the research changes decisions

IF WE HEAR	THEN WE
Parents trust local sources and want the schedule shown with its source	Make the source label prominent and add national body links
Few parents would use a chatbot	Delay the chatbot and invest in search inside the guides
Parents want family contributions	Prioritize the shared time capsule
Tracking fatigue is the main reason people quit	Cut log fields and add one-tap entries